

How to use the Jira agent

A short, practical guide for using the local Jira MCP server from VS Code Copilot Chat.

1. What it is

A local **MCP server** (`jira-mcp`) that gives Copilot Chat a set of Jira tools (search issues, comment, transition, assign, link, attach, etc.) so you can manage your Service Desk queue by chatting in natural language.

- Auth: your Atlassian email + API token (stored locally in `.env`).
 - Site: `comtradegaming.atlassian.net`.
 - Project used: **CGG** (Comtradegaming Service Desk).
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2. One-time setup (already done)

✓ `.env` created with `JIRA_SITE`, `JIRA_EMAIL`, `JIRA_API_TOKEN` ✓ Dependencies installed via `uv sync` ✓ MCP server registered in `.vscode/mcp.json`

If you ever rotate the token: edit `.env` and restart the MCP server in VS Code (Command Palette → **MCP: Restart Server**).

3. Start using it

1. Open this folder in VS Code.
 2. Open **Copilot Chat** (sidebar).
 3. Switch the chat dropdown to **Agent** mode.
 4. Make sure the `jira` server is enabled (tools icon → check `jira`).
 5. Just ask, in plain English.
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4. Example prompts

Read / search:

- "Show my open CGG tickets, newest first."
- "Find CGG tickets with status 'Waiting for support'."
- "Summarize CGG-258."
- "What transitions are available on CGG-255?"

Write / act:

- "Add a comment on CGG-258: 'Forwarded to SOFTSWISS, awaiting response.'"
- "Move CGG-256 to Resolved."
- "Assign CGG-257 to me."
- "Link CGG-258 as 'Relates' to CGG-255."
- "Attach `report.pdf` to CGG-254."

The agent will pick the right tool, ask for confirmation on destructive actions, and show you the result.

5. Available tools (what the agent can do)

Read helpers

- `get_current_user` — who am I
- `list_projects` — list/search projects
- `search_users` — find a user (to get accountId for assigning)
- `list_transitions` — workflow steps available on an issue
- `list_issue_link_types` — valid link types (Blocks, Relates, ...)

Actions

- `search_issues` — JQL search
 - `get_issue` — full details for one issue
 - `add_comment` — post a comment (plain text auto-wrapped to ADF)
 - `transition_issue` — close / move an issue (e.g. "Resolve this issue")
 - `assign_issue` — assign to a user (or "me")
 - `update_issue` — edit fields (summary, description, priority, ...)
 - `link_issues` — create a link between two issues
 - `add_attachment / list_attachments` — file attachments
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6. Useful JQL snippets

Goal	JQL
My open tickets	<code>project = CGG AND assignee = currentUser() AND statusCategory != Done</code>
Newest in queue	<code>project = CGG ORDER BY created DESC</code>
Waiting on customer	<code>project = CGG AND status = "Waiting for customer"</code>
Resolved this week	<code>project = CGG AND resolved >= startOfWeek()</code>
Unassigned	<code>project = CGG AND assignee is EMPTY</code>

You can paste any of these into a prompt: *"Run this JQL: ..."*.

7. Troubleshooting

- **"Tool not found" / jira missing in Copilot:** Command Palette → **MCP: List Servers** → restart jira.
- **401 / 403 errors:** token expired or revoked → generate a new one at <https://id.atlassian.com/manage-profile/security/api-tokens>, update `.env`, restart the server.
- **Wrong transition name:** ask the agent "list transitions for CGG-XXX" first — workflows differ per project.
- **Verify auth manually:**

```
cd "~/Documents/JIRA SUP"
.venv/bin/python -c "from dotenv import load_dotenv; load_dotenv(); \
import asyncio; from jira_mcp.client import request; \
print(asyncio.run(request('GET', '/myself'))['displayName'])"
```

8. Safety notes

- `.env` is gitignored — do not commit it.
- Never paste your API token into chat or share it in screenshots.
- The agent will confirm before destructive actions, but always double-check the issue key before approving a transition or comment.

